

Ideation Phase

Brainstorm & Idea Prioritization Template

Date	3 October 2026
Team ID	SWTID-2026-9693
Project Name	streamlining IT Procurement: Automating Standard Laptop Orders with Flow Designer
Maximum Marks	4 Marks

Brainstorm & Idea Prioritization :

Brainstorming provides a free and collaborative environment for the team to generate ideas for improving the **Standard Laptop Procurement** process. Team members can freely share ideas without immediately judging or rejecting them.

The brainstorming process focuses on identifying solutions to problems such as **manual approval follow-up, manual Catalog Task creation, incorrect or delayed assignment to the Hardware team, and limited visibility of request status.**

The team can explore different ideas such as **automating task creation using ServiceNow Flow Designer, automatically assigning approved requests to the Hardware group, standardizing task descriptions, and improving request tracking.** These ideas can then be discussed and refined to develop an effective automated laptop procurement workflow.

Step-1: Team Gathering, Collaboration and Select the Problem Statement



Brainstorm & Idea Prioritization

Use this template in your own brainstorming sessions so your team can unleash their imagination and start shaping concepts for improving the **Standard Laptop Procurement** process even if you're not sitting in the same room.

- 10 minutes to prepare
- 1 hour to collaborate
- 3-6 people recommended (Employee, Approver, IT/Hardware Team)

**Objective**

Generate as many ideas as possible to solve the challenges in the **Standard Laptop Procurement** process using ServiceNow automation and improve the experience for employees and the IT/Hardware team.

**Before you collaborate**

A little bit of preparation goes a long way with this session. Here's what you need to do to get going.

10 minutes

**Team gathering**

Include team members such as: Employees (requesters), Managers (approvers), IT/Hardware team, and ServiceNow administrators.

**Set the goal**

Generate ideas to make the Standard Laptop Procurement process faster, simpler, and more transparent using ServiceNow (e.g., Flow Designer, automation, catalog enhancements).

**Materials / Tools**

Use sticky notes, whiteboard, or an online tool (e.g., Miro, MS Teams) to capture ideas.

**Focus Areas**

Request submission (Service Catalog)	Automation using Flow Designer
Approval process	Role and responsibilities
Task creation & assignment	Standardization of task details
Notification and tracking	Any other improvement ideas

**1 Define your problem statement**

What problem are you trying to solve? Frame your problem as a How Might We statement. This will be the focus of your brainstorming.

5 minutes

How might we...

How might we automate the Standard Laptop Procurement process so that approved requests automatically create and assign tasks to the Hardware team and provide better visibility to employees?

**Key rules of brainstorming**

To run a smooth and productive session

 Stay in topic.	 Encourage wild ideas.
 Defer judgment.	 Listen to others.
 Go for volume.	 If possible, be visual.

Step-2: Brainstorm, Idea Listing and Grouping

2 Brainstorm

Write down any ideas that come to mind that address your problem statement.

TIP
No idea is too small or too big at this stage. Write down every idea that comes to mind.

10 minutes

Employee (Requester)	Manager (Approver)	IT/Hardware Team	ServiceNow Admin
Easy request form	Show estimated delivery date	Simple approval interface	Email notifications
Real-time status tracking	Allow custom remarks	View request details clearly	Bulk approval option
		Automatic task creation	Auto assignment to Hardware group
		Standard task description	View all pending requests in one place
		Use Flow Designer for automation	Configure notifications
		Maintain audit logs	Scalable and reusable process

HR Team	Finance Team	Security Team	Other Ideas
Automatically confirm employee onboarding	Trigger laptop request for new joiners	Budget approval workflow	Track laptop costs
Track laptop allocation status	Integrate with HR data	Cost center mapping	Approval based on financial policy
		Enforce standard laptop model	Compliance checks before approval
		Track asset assignment	Ensure data security policies
		Self-service cancellation	Send reminders for pending tasks
		Dashboard for request statistics	Feedback after laptop delivery

3 Group ideas

Take turns sharing your ideas with clustering similar or related ideas. As you do, in the last 10 minutes, give each cluster a sentence-like label. If a cluster is bigger than six sticky notes, try and see if you can break it up into smaller sub-groups.

20 minutes

Request Submission

- Easy request form
- Allow custom remarks
- Self-service cancellation
- Show estimated delivery date

Approval Process

- Simple approval interface
- Bulk approval option
- Budget approval workflow
- Approval based on financial policy

Task Creation & Assignment

- Automatic task creation
- Auto assignment to Hardware group
- Standard task description
- Send reminders for pending tasks

Notification & Communication

- Email notifications
- Real-time status tracking
- Notifications to requester and approver
- Alerts for delays

IT/Hardware Processing

- View all pending requests in one place
- Track asset assignment
- Compliance checks before approval
- Ensure data security policies

Tracking & Reporting

- Dashboard for request statistics
- Track laptop costs
- Maintain audit logs
- Feedback after laptop delivery

TIP
Add a cluster name or sentence-like label that summarizes the ideas. Break large clusters into smaller sub-groups if needed.

Step-: Idea Prioritization

